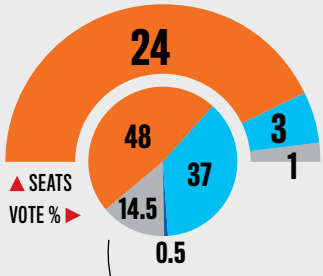
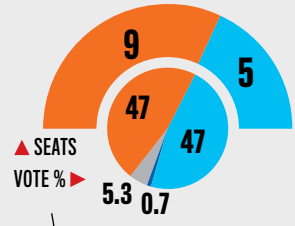
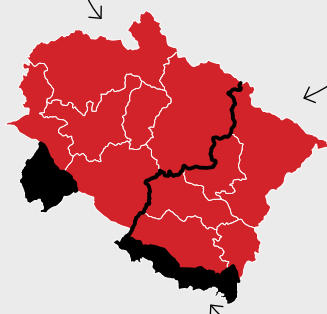
HOW UTTARAKHAND VOTED IN 2022

GARHWAL
TOTAL SEATS: **28**

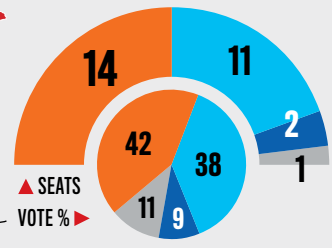


KUMAON
TOTAL SEATS: **14**





TERAI
TOTAL SEATS: **28**



WHY THEY VOTED FOR THE BJP

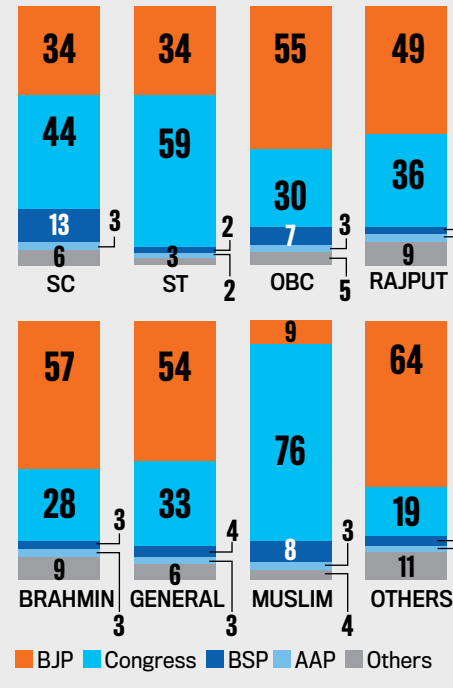
1. PM Modi's brand and the appeal for Hindutva still go a long way in the hill state. His reputation as a doer and the 'double engine' track the BJP plays still gets traction

2. The massive infighting in the Congress put off voters. Septuagenarian Harish Rawat, who was finally given charge of the party campaign after much drama, could not even get his seat of choice and had little say in candidate selection

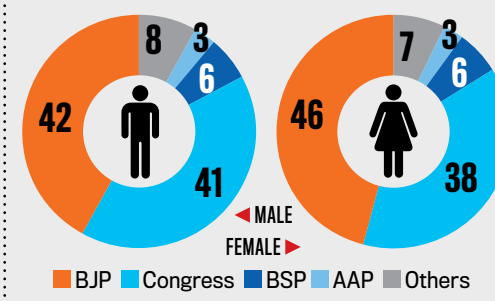
3. Though he lost the polls himself, CM Pushkar Dhami had the image of being a doer and, being young, was popular among the youth

BREAK-UP OF VOTES

CASTE-WISE VOTE SHARE



GENDER-WISE VOTE SHARE



(Figures in %)

Source: India Today-Axis My India Exit poll

for October-December 2020 showed that 27 per cent of those in the 15-29 age group in Uttarakhand were jobless (national average was 25 per cent). The graph had peaked at 38 per cent during the lockdowns, and never receded to the pre-Covid level of 21 per cent.

Adding to the pressure, some 500,000 natives migrated back to the state during the pandemic. Worst of all, neither regular industry in the state's south nor the tourism segment in the hills has recovered from the massive hit they took. The India Today-Axis My India exit poll suggests that nearly 40 per cent of the electorate below 35 voted for the BJP—this is almost a percentage point less than the Congress. "The bulk of them returned to the party in the past six months," claims a BJP leader. The BJP had fielded 22 new faces, 14 of them younger than even Dhami; 18 of them won. Dhami's promise to bring new faces into government may have been fulfilled a little more thoroughly than he intended, but there's hope for him. While beginning the process to select a new CM, the BJP is open to reinstating him should he get re-elected to the assembly in the next six months. MLAs Suresh Gariya (Kapkot) and Kailash Chandra Gahtori (Champawat) have offered to vacate their seats for Dhami to contest. BJP leaders in Delhi believe Dhami did well to contain anti-incumbency and should be compensated. ■